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Question

Mosses can struggle in harsh desert conditions because these plants require enough sunlight for photosynthesis but not so much that they risk drying out. Researchers Jenna Ekwealor and Kirsten M. Fisher found several species of *Syntrichia caninervis*, a type of desert moss, growing under quartz crystals in California's Mojave Desert. To evaluate whether these semitransparent rocks benefited the moss, the researchers compared the shoot tissue, a measure of plant growth, of *S. caninervis* when growing on the soil surface versus when the moss was growing under the quartz rocks. They found that the shoot tissue was 62% longer for moss growing under the quartz as compared to moss on the soil surface, suggesting that ______

Which choice most logically completes the text?

Answer

A. *S. caninervis* is one of the few types of moss that can survive under semitransparent rocks.

B. quartz crystals do not transmit the necessary sunlight for photosynthesis in *S. caninervis*.

C. *S. caninervis* growing under quartz crystals experience lower light intensity and are thus able to retain more moisture.

D. quartz crystals are capable of supporting *S. caninervis* growth if the crystals are not too thin.